WARLOCK SUBCLASS · D&D 2024

The Outsider

Your patron is a bored god in a pale suit, adrift in the Void. He marks those he finds interesting, gives them power, and watches what they do with it. He asks nothing in return.

V0.1 PLAYTEST WARLOCK PATRON INSPIRED BY DISHONORED

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Outsider warlocks bear the Mark on the back of one hand. Every Marked character shares the core kit below. The Outsider invocations let each player build toward Corvo, Emily, Daud, Billie, or a mix of them.

LEVEL 3

Outsider Spells

The Outsider whispers the secrets of hiding, seeing, and controlling others. When you reach a Warlock level listed below, you always have the listed spells prepared.

WARLOCK LEVEL	SPELLS
3	*Charm Person, Disguise Self, Pass without Trace, See Invisibility*
5	*Clairvoyance, Slow*
7	*Dominate Beast, Greater Invisibility*
9	*Dominate Person, Mislead*

LEVEL 3

The Mark

You gain the following benefits.

Blink. As a Bonus Action, you teleport up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space you can see. You can use Blink a number of times equal to your Charisma modifier (minimum of once), and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Short or Long Rest. When you have no uses left, you can expend a Pact Magic spell slot (no action required) to regain one use.

Void Sight. As a Bonus Action, you can expend one use of Blink to see through the Void for 1 minute. During that time, you sense the location of every creature within 60 feet of you, even through walls and other obstacles, and you know which direction each one is facing. You also learn whether each creature is a Beast, Construct, Humanoid, or something else.

LEVEL 6

Shadow Step

The Void carries you farther and quieter. You gain the following benefits.

- **Long Blink.** Blink's range becomes 60 feet.
- **Unseen Arrival.** Blinking doesn't end your Invisible condition or reveal you if you have the Hide action's benefits, as long as your destination would also keep you hidden.

- **Ambush.** When you Blink to a space within 5 feet of a creature that couldn't see you before the teleport, you have Advantage on the next attack roll you make against it before the end of your turn.
- **Void Leap.** When you fall, you can take a Reaction and expend one use of Blink to teleport to a space you can see within range. You take no falling damage.

LEVEL 10

Bend Time

You can make time stand still around you. As a Bonus Action, choose any number of creatures you can see within 120 feet of you. Each target makes a Wisdom saving throw against your spell save DC. On a failed save, a target is frozen in time until the start of your next turn.

A frozen creature has the Incapacitated condition and a Speed of 0. Taking damage doesn't end the effect. The creature perceives nothing that happens while it's frozen, so when time resumes, it doesn't know where you went or what you did.

Once you use this feature, you can't do so again until you finish a Long Rest unless you expend a Pact Magic spell slot (no action required) to restore your use of it.

LEVEL 14

Stop Time

The world holds its breath for you. When you use Bend Time, you gain the following benefits.

- **Longer Pause.** The effect lasts until the end of your next turn.
- **Helpless Targets.** Frozen creatures automatically fail Strength and Dexterity saving throws, and attack rolls against them have Advantage.
- **Deeper Well.** You can use Bend Time twice, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a Long Rest.

Outsider Invocations

These Eldritch Invocations require the Outsider patron. They're grouped by the protagonist who wielded them, but any Marked warlock can mix and match. Invocations marked (**modifies Blink**) use Blink's uses rather than a resource of their own.

Corvo Attano

Windblast *Prerequisite: Outsider patron.* As a Magic action, you unleash a blast of Void wind in a 15-foot cone. Each creature in the cone makes a Strength saving throw. On a failed save, a creature takes 2d8 Bludgeoning damage, is pushed 20 feet away from you, and has the Prone condition. On a successful save, it takes half as much damage only. The blast also extinguishes unprotected flames and bursts open unlocked doors and shutters. The damage increases to 3d8 at Warlock level 7 and 4d8 at level 13. You can use this once per Short or Long Rest, or by expending a Pact Magic spell slot.

Devouring Swarm *Prerequisite: Level 5+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* As a Magic action, you can expend a Pact Magic spell slot to call a swarm of plague rats into an unoccupied space within 60 feet of you. Use the Swarm of Rats stat block. The swarm lasts for 1 minute (Concentration), acts immediately after you in Initiative, and obeys your mental commands. Any corpse in the swarm's space at the end of its turn is devoured, leaving only bones. At Warlock level 11, you call two swarms.

Possession *Prerequisite: Level 5+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* As a Magic action, you can expend a Pact Magic spell slot to slip into the body of a Beast you can see within 30 feet of you. The Beast makes a Charisma saving throw, and it fails automatically if it's Tiny. On a failed save, you vanish into its body and control it for up to 1 minute (Concentration). You use its game statistics except your Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma scores. You can't be targeted while inside it, and damage to the host doesn't harm you. When the effect ends or the host drops to 0 Hit Points, you reappear in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of it. At Warlock level 12, you can possess Humanoids as well. When you leave a possessed Humanoid, it has the Stunned condition until the end of its next turn and doesn't remember what happened.

Shadow Kill *Prerequisite: Level 5+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* When you reduce a creature to 0 Hit Points on your turn, you can enter a **Void Frenzy** (no action required). The frenzy lasts until the end of your next turn. Each time you reduce a creature to 0 Hit Points during it, the frenzy extends to the end of your next turn, up to a maximum of 1 minute. While frenzied, you gain the following benefits:

- Blink costs no uses, and once per turn you can Blink as part of your movement instead of as a Bonus Action.
- Creatures you slay burn to ash. Each enemy within 10 feet of a creature that burns makes a Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the enemy has the Frightened condition until the end of its next turn.

Once you use this invocation, you can't do so again until you finish a Long Rest unless you expend a Pact Magic spell slot to use it again. *Chaos Tracker (optional rule): each Void Frenzy adds 1 Chaos.*

Emily Kaldwin

Far Reach (**modifies Blink**) *Prerequisite: Outsider patron.* When you use Blink, you can choose one of these options instead of teleporting:

- **Tether.** You fly along a visible line of Void energy to the destination. This lets you catch a ledge, swing over a gap, or pass around a corner you can see past.
- **Yank.** You pull a creature or an unattended object of Medium size or smaller from up to Blink's range to a space within 5 feet of you. An unwilling creature makes a Strength saving throw to resist. If it fails, you can make one melee attack against it as part of the same Bonus Action.

Domino *Prerequisite: Level 5+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* As a Bonus Action, you can expend one use of Blink to link up to three creatures you can see within 60 feet of you. Each target makes a Charisma saving throw. Those that fail are linked for 1 minute (Concentration). Once per turn, when a linked creature takes damage from you, each other linked creature takes half that damage. When a linked creature gains a condition from one of your spells or features, each other linked creature makes the same save or gains it too. At Warlock level 11, you can link up to four creatures.

Doppelganger *Prerequisite: Level 7+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* As a Bonus Action, you can expend one use of Blink to create a shadow double of yourself in an unoccupied space within 30 feet of you. It lasts for 1 minute or until it takes any damage. It has your AC and moves up to 30 feet when you do. While you're within 30 feet of the double, attack rolls against you have Disadvantage, because enemies can't tell which of you is real. As a Bonus Action, you can swap places with the double; this doesn't cost a use of Blink.

Mesmerize *Prerequisite: Level 5+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* You always have *Hypnotic Pattern* prepared, and it counts as a Warlock spell for you. You can cast it once without a spell slot, and you regain the ability to do so when you finish a Long Rest. The pattern looks like a floating Void spirit.

Shadow Walk *Prerequisite: Level 7+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* As a Bonus Action, you can expend one use of Blink to become a creeping shadow for up to 1 minute (Concentration). While in this form, your Speed increases by 10 feet, you have the Invisible condition while in Dim Light or Darkness, and you can move through any space at least 1 inch wide. You can't cast spells or make attacks except to end the form. You can end the form when you make a melee attack. That attack has Advantage and deals an extra 3d6 Necrotic damage if it hits.

Daud

Pull *Prerequisite: Outsider patron.* You can cast *Mage Hand* at will. The hand is invisible and can carry up to 50 pounds. In addition, as a Bonus Action, you can expend one use of Blink to wrench a weapon or other held object from a creature within 60 feet of you. The creature makes a Strength saving throw. On a failed save, the object flies into your free hand or lands at your feet.

Summon Assassin *Prerequisite: Level 7+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* As a Magic action, you can expend a Pact Magic spell slot to summon a Whaler assassin in an unoccupied space within 30 feet of you. It lasts for 1 hour (Concentration) and dissolves into black smoke when it drops to 0 Hit Points. It's an ally to you, acts immediately after you in Initiative, and obeys your commands. If you give none, it takes the Dodge action.

Whaler Assassin — Medium Humanoid. AC 13 + the spell slot's level. HP 30 + 10 for each slot level above 3. Speed 30 ft. Uses your spell attack modifier and save DC.

- **Multiattack.** The Whaler makes a number of Wrist Blade attacks equal to half the slot's level (round down).
- **Wrist Blade.** Melee Attack Roll: your spell attack modifier, reach 5 ft. Hit: 1d8 + 3 + the slot's level Slashing damage.
- **Transversal** (**Bonus Action**). The Whaler teleports up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space it can see.

Billie Lurk

Displace (**modifies Blink**) *Prerequisite: Outsider patron.* When you use Blink, you can place a marker at the destination instead of teleporting. The marker is visible only to you and lasts for 1 hour. While it lasts, you can teleport to it as a Bonus Action without expending a use of Blink,

as long as you're within 500 feet of it and on the same plane of existence. The marker vanishes when you use it. At Warlock level 9, you can instead swap places with a willing creature standing at the marker.

Foresight *Prerequisite: Level 5+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* As a Magic action, you can expend one use of Blink to send your spirit out of your body for up to 10 minutes (Concentration). Your body has the Incapacitated condition. Your spirit has the Invisible condition, a Fly Speed of 60 feet, and can pass through objects, but it can't interact with anything. The spirit returns immediately if your body takes damage. While your spirit is out, you can:

- Mark up to a number of creatures equal to your Charisma modifier. For 1 hour, you know the direction and distance to each marked creature within 1 mile of you.
- Place your Displace marker where your spirit is, if you have that invocation.

Semblance *Prerequisite: Level 5+ Warlock, Outsider patron.* As a Magic action, you can expend one use of Blink to touch a Humanoid that has the Incapacitated or Unconscious condition and steal its face. For 1 hour, you look and sound exactly like that creature. No ability check can reveal the disguise, though *True Seeing* and similar magic can. The victim's face becomes a smooth blank until the effect ends. The effect ends early if you make an attack roll, cast a spell, or deal damage.

Sample Builds

BUILD	PACT	INVOCATIONS, IN SUGGESTED ORDER
Corvo	Pact of the Blade	Windblast, Devouring Swarm, Possession, Shadow Kill
Emily	Pact of the Blade	Far Reach, Domino, Mesmerize, Doppelganger, Shadow Walk
Daud	Pact of the Blade	Pull, Windblast, Summon Assassin
Billie	Pact of the Blade	Displace, Foresight, Semblance

PLAYTEST NOTES

The biggest risks are Blink's action economy and the high-level time and mind-control effects.

- **Blink and the Bonus Action.** Blink, Domino, Doppelganger, and Shadow Walk all compete for the Bonus Action. That's intended, but watch whether it crowds out Pact of the Blade play.
- **Blink uses.** Charisma-mod uses per Short Rest may feel tight at low levels for Far Reach and Displace builds. Possible fix: Proficiency Bonus uses instead.
- **Void Frenzy chains.** In minion-heavy fights, free Blinks every turn could run away. Watch the 1-minute cap and whether the Chaos cost is enough of a brake.
- **Bend Time and Stop Time.** A mass Incapacitate on a Bonus Action is strong. At 14, Advantage plus auto-failed Dex saves sets up huge nova turns for the whole party.
- **Possession.** Humanoid Possession at 12 is a scouting and infiltration powerhouse. DMs may want to cap the target's CR.
- **Domino.** Check that half-damage sharing doesn't snowball with area spells like *Hypnotic Pattern* or *Slow*.
- **Chaos Tracker.** An optional rule, coming soon. Void Frenzy adds 1 Chaos, and Turmoil grants Outsider warlocks an extra Blink use.

V0.1 PLAYTEST: FIRST PUBLIC RELEASE

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